



Delaware County Council Meeting December 8th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zgSzoPNd244
Publication Date	2020-12-08T20:12:08Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: December 8, 2020

Body: Delaware County Council

Location: Commissioners' Courtroom (Hybrid format with members attending via Zoom)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order shortly after 9:00 a.m. by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present (In-Person & Zoom):** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes, and Mr. Blood (noted during roll call setup/attendance).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as the council president/chair leading the agenda.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:18 Presiding officer led the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Agenda:** [00:01:54](#) The agenda was approved by roll call vote following a motion by Ms. Piper and a second by Mr. Ballard (Mr. Quakenbush abstained).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:02:48](#) Commissioners Department <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jenny (Commissioners' office / financial administration).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion centered on a series of fund transfers totaling zero net change (−\\$85,000 to health insurance; +\\$10,000 to telephones; +\\$75,000 to utilities; −\\$45,000 to health insurance; +\\$45,000 to juvenile center contract; +\\$30,000 to insurance). Staff explained that liability and insurance premiums create a domino effect requiring funds to be shifted across accounts throughout the year, compounded by rising utility costs at the old jail facility.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

[00:12:12](#) Clerk Department <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk, participating via text/phone due to quarantine).
- **Deliberation Summary:** [00:12:12](#) Transfers included deputy clerk (−\\$4,000), part-time (−\\$12,000), office supplies (+\\$17,000), and equipment repair (−\\$1,000) for a net-zero request. Council members briefly debated whether furniture purchases could be appropriately categorized under office supplies.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:48:37](#).

[00:25:31](#) Election Department <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Scott / Election staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** [00:25:31](#) Transfer involving supplies (−\\$5,000), contractual services (+\\$21,000), and office machines (−\\$16,000) for a net-zero request.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

[00:26:30](#) Circuit Court <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
- **Deliberation Summary:** [00:26:30](#) Transfer of −\\$300 from court-ordered testing to +\\$300 for office equipment (specifically covering laptop return camera cost differences and a new staff chair). Net-zero request.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:28:04 Coroner <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Coroner).
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:28:04 Transfer of +\\$1,000 to part-time and -\\$1,000 to evidence bags (net-zero request). The coroner reported a severe caseload surge (jumping from ~350 total cases last year to nearly 600 cases and 220 autopsies this year), driven by drug overdoses, suicides, and lockdown impacts. Council discussed potential CARES Act or infant fatality grant reimbursements.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:32:10 Communication Center (9-1-1) <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:32:10 Transfer of +\\$3,000 to holiday pay and -\\$3,000 to part-time (net-zero request) to cover payroll shortfalls through the end of the year.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:33:25 Data Processing (IJS / IT) <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim (IT / Data Processing).
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:33:25 Transfer of -\\$4,000 from equipment maintenance to +\\$4,000 for office furniture (net-zero request) for IT staff moving to the new justice center facility. Discussion included phone system rollovers, fiber connections, backup servers, and laptop distribution.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:49:17 Public Defender <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelly Harvey, Office Administrator.
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:49:17 Transfer of +\\$2,000 to longevity, -\\$600 to court interpreter, and -\\$1,400 to transcript expense (net-zero request) to clear up a shortfall in the longevity line.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:50:19 Highway Department <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie Dye, County Highway.

- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:50:19 Transfer of –\\$400 from life insurance to +\\$400 for long-term disability (net-zero request) to cover rate changes through year-end.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:51:16 Prosecutor <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:51:16 Transfer of +\\$600 to longevity and –\\$600 to PERF (net-zero request) to correct a missed longevity budget line.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:52:10 Plan Commission <U+2013> Budget Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Marta (Plan Commission).
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:52:10 Transfer of +\\$965.50 to part-time, +\\$949.98 to printing, and –\\$15.52 to dues and subscriptions (net-zero request) to correct an over-reported fund reversion from a prior budget cycle.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:56:59 Board Appointments <U+2013> 9-1-1 Communications Board

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** 00:56:59 The council considered appointing a representative to the 9-1-1 Communications Board, which begins meeting after the first of the year.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote appointing **Ryan Ballard** (Mr. Ballard abstained).

00:58:57 Ordinance 2020-22: GIS Fees (Second Reading)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal counsel / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** 00:58:57 The council conducted the second reading of Ordinance 2020-22 regarding GIS data and services fees. County attorney Bill clarified that specific statutory authority (IC 5-14) explicitly mandates county council approval for GIS data fee ordinances, distinguishing it from standard commissioner-set fees.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:11:47 Sheriff Tony Skinner:** Addressed the council to publicly thank outgoing council member Larry Bledsoe for his years of service, bipartisan collaboration, and strong advocacy for public safety and the sheriff's office. Council members echoed these sentiments, praising Mr. Bledsoe's experience and contributions.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Special Meeting & Reorganization:** **01:03:15** The council voted to schedule a special meeting and reorganizational meeting for **January 4, 2021, at 10:00 a.m.** (following the commissioners' meeting).
 - **Highway Funding & CREED Funds:** **01:03:44** Ongoing discussions involving the auditor, council attorney, and commissioners regarding highway budget funding shortfalls and the legal utilization of CREED funds/State Board of Accounts guidelines.
 - **Electronic Signatures & Oaths:** Members on Zoom granted approval for electronic signatures on paperwork, and incoming members were reminded to file their oaths of office and conflict-of-interest statements.
 - **Adjournment:** **01:16:53** Approved by roll call vote following a motion by Mr. Ryan and second by Ms. Jessica. Meeting adjourned.
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